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A FIELD GUIDE FROM PERSEVERANT DIGITAL · FOR RECRUITING AND STAFFING

How to Win Employer Clients Who Send Repeat Job Orders

Business development keeps stalling while your desks stay busy. Here is a plan to win employers who come back with their next job order, and to know what each new client costs.

THE SHORT ANSWER · 60 WORDS

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Win repeat employer clients by leading with the hard-to-fill roles you place well, being the firm Google and AI assistants name for those roles in your region, offering hiring managers something useful, replying to every employer inquiry within minutes, and following up with compliant email. Then track cost per new client and per repeat job order, not clicks or downloads.

Your recruiters are measured on fills, so business development happens in the gaps. It surges after a slow month and stalls when desks get busy. A few accounts carry the revenue, and one hiring freeze puts a hole in the year.

Cold email that worked a few years ago can now land in spam. The website ranks for job seekers, so most inquiries are résumés, not job orders. And when an HR director asks ChatGPT which firm places nurses or controls engineers in your region, it may name a competitor.

Staffing Industry Analysts expects the US staffing market to grow 2.4% in 2026, to $183.1 billion (SIA, September 6, 2026). In a slow-growth year, new accounts tend to go to firms that are easy to find, easy to reach and quick to answer. This guide is the plan.

Where will your next employer clients come from?

Start with where your current clients came from; that is where the next ones most likely are. Pull the last ten new employer accounts from your ATS or CRM and fill this in.

Client (initials)	How they first found us	Who brought it in	Days from first contact to first job order	Job orders in first 12 months

Group the sources and note what each cost in money and recruiter hours.

Two patterns often show up. Repeat job orders come from a few role families you fill well, and good accounts started with an inbound inquiry someone almost missed.

Which roles should you lead with?

Lead with the client's hardest roles, not your talent pool. "We have 40,000 candidates" describes you. "We fill second-shift maintenance technicians across Northeast Ohio" describes the employer's problem.

Use your placement history to pick three to five role families where you have a real track record.

Role family	Region	Placements last 24 months	Typical margin or fee	Repeat clients in this role	Why it is hard for employers

Rank by margin and repeat rate, not volume. An IT desk might lead with cloud security engineers, a healthcare firm with travel ICU nurses, an executive search firm with CFOs for founder-owned manufacturers.

State any time-to-fill as your own history, never a promise.

Does an employer find you when they search or ask an AI assistant?

Many staffing websites are built for job seekers. The job board drives the traffic, so Google learns that the site is about jobs. Employers searching for help with a hard role find someone else.

The searches have also moved. Google says AI Mode passed 1 billion monthly users (Alphabet Q2 2026 earnings remarks, July 22, 2026). OpenAI reports more than 900 million weekly ChatGPT users (February 27, 2026). The firm named in the answer is more likely to get the call.

We call this Search Essence Optimization: an employer is not just trying to find a staffing firm, they are trying to understand which one fits their problem. Give them, and the assistants, a clear page for each role family and region you lead with: what you fill, where, how your fee works and what the first 30 days look like.

Test what assistants say today. Ask ChatGPT, Google AI Mode and Gemini prompts like these, and note who gets named:

- [ ] “Which staffing firms place [role] in [region]?”
- [ ] “Contract-to-hire vs direct hire for a [role]: which is better?”
- [ ] “How much does a recruiter charge to place a [role]?”
- [ ] “Who can staff a second shift of [role] in [city] within two weeks?”
- [ ] Repeat for each role family, then note which sources the answers cite

Test employer prompts only. Keep a Google Business Profile for each staffed branch.

What gets a hiring manager to raise a hand?

Give hiring managers something useful before you ask for a meeting. The most direct offer is a short hiring needs call. For managers not ready to talk, try a salary guide or hiring-outlook webinar for one role family.

Offer	Best for	Keep it clean
Hiring needs call	Any employer with an open role	Say what the call covers and how long it takes
Salary guide for one role family	Managers planning next year's hires	Name the salary data source and date
Hiring-outlook webinar	Operations, plant and HR leaders	No promised time-to-fill
"Cost of an open role" worksheet	Owners with roles open too long	Label example numbers as examples

ON24, an enterprise webinar platform, reported an average registrant-to-attendee conversion of 60% in its 2025 data, mostly B2B enterprise events (June 19, 2026). Count replay viewers as warm too.

LinkedIn reaches titles directly, so test it with one clear offer and watch cost per meeting. On Meta, job ads fall under the employment Special Ad Category: age targeting fixed at 18–65+, gender and ZIP targeting restricted, no lookalike audiences (Meta Marketing API documentation). Ads selling your service to employers generally do not, but check each campaign. Keep employer and candidate campaigns fully separate. This is not legal advice.

How fast do you answer an employer who reaches out?

Answer within minutes, with a person. An employer who fills out a form often has a role open now and other firms on the list.

Harvard Business Review's audit of 2,241 US companies found 37% responded to a web lead within an hour, 23% never responded, and the average response took 42 hours. Firms that made contact within an hour were nearly seven times as likely to qualify the lead (HBR, March 2011).

- [ ] Employer inquiries route to a named person, not a shared inbox, with a backup when that person is out
- [ ] The employer form is separate from the candidate application, so job orders never sit behind résumés
- [ ] A text or call goes back within 15 minutes during business hours
- [ ] After-hours inquiries get a human reply by 9 a.m.
- [ ] The first reply asks about the role, timeline and decision-makers

- [ ] Every inquiry is logged on the company record in your ATS, with its source

This week, submit your own employer form at 4:45 p.m. on a Friday and time the reply.

How do you follow up without landing in spam?

Follow up by email, on the employer's hiring calendar, from a properly set-up domain. If messages land in spam, a common cause is missing setup required by the 2024 sender rules.

Since February 1, 2024, Google requires senders of 5,000+ messages a day to Gmail to set up SPF, DKIM and DMARC, offer one-click unsubscribe and keep the spam rate under 0.30%, ideally below 0.10% (Google email sender guidelines). Yahoo has similar rules and expects unsubscribes honored within two days. The FTC's CAN-SPAM guide says the law makes no exception for business-to-business email: accurate headers, a postal address and an opt-out honored within 10 business days. This is not legal advice.

- [ ] SPF, DKIM and DMARC set on every sending domain
- [ ] One-click unsubscribe, honored within two days
- [ ] Business development email sent from a separate stream from candidate job alerts
- [ ] Lists built from people who asked, attended or replied
- [ ] Spam rate checked weekly in Google Postmaster Tools
- [ ] Check LinkedIn's terms before using any tool that sends on your behalf

Then use the data you already have. Your ATS holds every client who went quiet and every hiring manager who moved companies. A manager who hired through you at one company is your warmest lead at their next one. Time notes to budget season, the new year and seasonal ramp-ups.

What does a new employer client cost you?

Measure cost per new employer client and job orders per client, not clicks, downloads or webinar seats. Here is the formula:

Cost per new client = (ad spend + tools + content + recruiter hours on business development × hourly cost) ÷ new employer clients with a first job order

First-year value = job orders in the first 12 months × average gross profit per placement

Example numbers, not benchmarks: a firm spends $3,000 a month on ads and tools and 30 recruiter hours at $50 an hour, or $4,500 a month. Over a quarter, $13,500 brings in 5 new clients. That is $2,700 per new client. If a typical new client sends 4 job orders a year at $6,000 gross profit each, first-year value is $24,000.

Use a typical new account, not your largest. Track by source:

Source	Spend	Inquiries	Meetings held	New clients	Job orders, 12 months	Cost per new client
Referrals						
Outbound email						
LinkedIn						
Website and search						
Webinars and events						

Put the source on the company record. Hiring managers change jobs.

Where do most owners get stuck?

> **Turning the website toward employers.** Rebuilding pages around role families and regions without losing the job seeker traffic takes planning and testing most firms do not have time for.

> **Keeping deliverability healthy.** Domain setup, separate sending streams and spam-rate monitoring are technical, and one bad list can hurt every email you send.

> **Getting the data out of the ATS.** Linking first touch, meetings and job orders to the company record takes careful setup in Bullhorn, Loxo or whatever you run.

If any of these sound familiar, book a 25-minute exploration call through the short form at the end of this guide.

Sources

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Want a second set of eyes on your plan?

Book a free 25-minute exploration call. We will look at your numbers with you, name the first fixes in order, and tell you honestly if we are not the right fit.

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